



The world of true wireless stereo (TWS) earphones has evolved rapidly over the past few years. Special attention has been given to the budget segment, where the price cap is typically around ₹5,000. Today, you don't have to spend a fortune to enjoy rather premium features. We set out to determine which TWS earbuds offer the best performance under ₹5,000, as well as which one stands out for offering the best value for money. Here are the winners of the Digit Zero1 and Best Buy Awards in the Best Budget TWS Earphones (Under ₹5,000) category for 2024.

Winner: CMF Buds Pro 2

The CMF Buds Pro 2 have emerged as the top TWS earbuds of 2024, bagging the Digit Zero1 Award for their killer performance. You get punchy, thumping bass that'll make EDM fans smile, without completely drowning out the mids and highs. The mids are slightly recessed but still clear enough for vocals and instruments to shine, while the highs add just the right amount of sparkle. Plus, thanks to LDAC support, Hi-Res audio is on the table for those who really care about sound quality. Noise cancellation? Solid. The ANC on these buds handles low-frequency sounds like AC hums and engine noise effortlessly. Sure, it's not perfect against sudden loud noises, but for the price, it's more than impressive. And the mics? Absolute champs. Calls come through loud and clear, even in noisy spots, making them great for work or catching up on the go. In a crowded market, the CMF Buds Pro 2 stand out by offering a premium experience at a budget-friendly price, earning their spot as 2024's best TWS earbuds in the budget segment.

Budget TWS earphones

Pocket friendly powerhouses



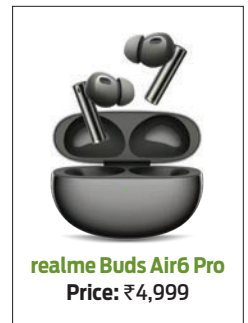
CMF Buds Pro 2
Price: ₹4,299



Sony WF-C510
Price: ₹4,990

Runner-Up: realme Buds Air6 Pro

The realme Buds Air6 Pro are a strong contender in the sub-₹5,000 TWS market, falling just short of the CMF Buds Pro 2, which snagged the top spot in the Digit Zero1 Awards. With a dual-driver setup, out of the box, the sound leans heavily on the bass, but its fairly well rounded. With ANC these buds managed to block out most of the low-frequency hum and mid-range chatter, making for a peaceful trip. High-pitched sounds do sneak through occasionally, but it's not a dealbreaker. While they couldn't edge out the CMF Buds Pro 2, they're still a fantastic option for anyone wanting a balanced mix of sound quality, ANC, and customisability.



realme Buds Air6 Pro
Price: ₹4,999

Best Buy: Sony WF-C510

The Sony WF-C510 earbuds are a budget-friendly audio gem, nabbing the Digit Best Buy Awards 2024 for their killer performance-to-price ratio. The WF-C510 delivers a clean, balanced sound that's surprisingly refined for the price. The bass is there but doesn't try to steal the show – perfect for those who want tight, controlled lows without overwhelming everything else. And thanks to Sony's DSEE tech, compressed tracks get a solid upgrade, so even your old playlists sound fresher. Comfort? Absolutely nailed it. These buds are lightweight, fit snugly, and come with multiple ear tip sizes to suit most ears. Plus, they're compact enough to disappear in your bag or pocket when not in use. You get 10 hours and 15 minutes on a single charge. While there's no ANC, the passive isolation does a solid job. You also get reliable Bluetooth connectivity and the physical controls are simple and work flawlessly, though it's worth noting that there's no LDAC support for audiophiles chasing ultra-high-res audio. For the price, though, the WF-C510 focuses on what matters: solid sound, comfort, and great battery life. It's easy to see why these took home the top spot this year.

—Sativik Pandey | sativik@digit.in